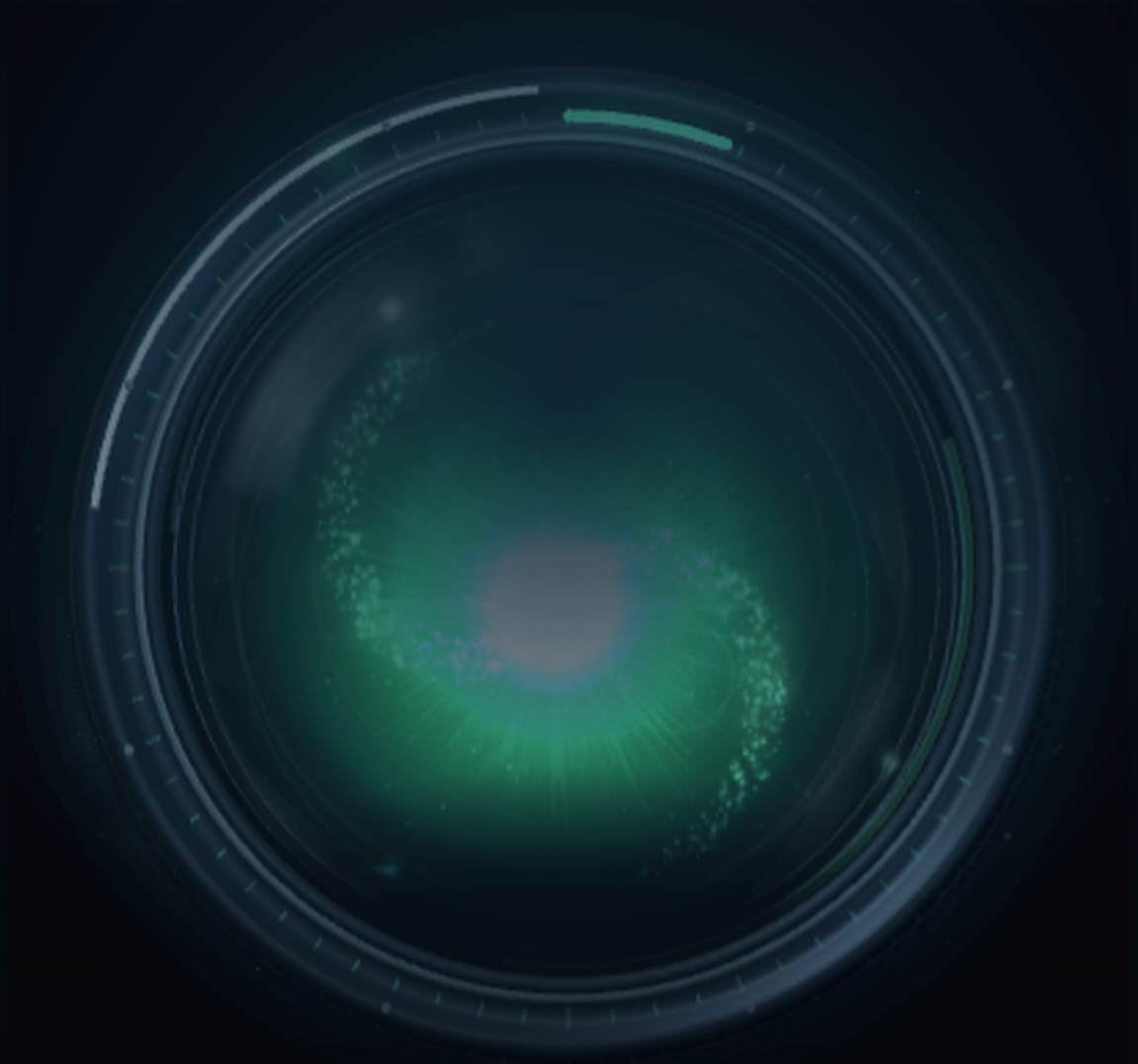


GETTING STARTED

VOID COMPASS

Installing, first-time setup, the command deck, overlays, Overlay Studio and your companion, step by step with screenshots.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Contents

01 Welcome aboard · what Void Compass does, and what you need

02 Installing · download, unzip, run

03 First-time setup · the four steps

04 Finding your way around the deck

05 Exploring · Explore & Survey and the Captain's Log

06 The Galactic Atlas and FOLLOW ME

07 Expeditions, the surface and your record

08 Overlays in the cockpit

09 Overlay Studio · placing and tuning overlays

10 Your companion · choosing, talking, voices and stories

11 Settings

12 Updates

13 Your data and your privacy

14 Troubleshooting and getting help

ABOUT THE SCREENSHOTS

The pictures in this guide come from Void Compass 5.7.4 reading a sample commander, CMDR Sample, flying a Krait Phantom called *Long Shadow*. Your own deck shows your commander, your ship and your journeys.

01 · WELCOME ABOARD

Your journey, remembered

Void Compass is a companion app for *Elite Dangerous*. It reads the journal and status files the game already writes, and turns them into a command deck on your desktop and a set of overlays in your cockpit.

It follows where you fly, what you scan and what you find, and it keeps a record of all of it: every system, every first discovery, every trip. A companion of your choice (the Watcher, Aster, Axiom or Meridian) flies with you, remarks on what you do, answers questions about your ship, and can work Elite's controls when you ask.

What it never does

- **It never changes your journals.** It only reads them.
- **It needs no account.** Everything runs and stays on your own PC.
- **It doesn't share anything you haven't switched on.** The community services it can use are listed in chapter 13, and each one can be turned off.

What you need

YOU NEED	NOTES
Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit	Void Compass is a Windows x64 app.
Microsoft Edge WebView2	Most Windows 10 and 11 PCs already have it. If the deck stays blank, install the *WebView2 Runtime* from Microsoft.
Elite Dangerous	Any version that writes journals (Horizons and Odyssey both do). The game doesn't have to be running for you to browse the deck.
Nothing else	No installer, no Python, no account.

02 · INSTALLING

Download, unzip, run

1. Download the latest release ZIP from github.com/insert3coins/VoidCompass/releases.
2. Extract the **whole** ZIP into a normal folder you can write to, such as `Documents\VoidCompass` or a folder on another drive. Don't run it from inside the ZIP.
3. Run **VoidCompass.exe**.

> **WINDOWS SMARTSCREEN**
>
> Community builds aren't code-signed, so Windows may say it doesn't recognise the app. Choose **More info**, then **Run anyway**. The release page publishes a SHA-256 checksum for every ZIP if you'd like to check your download.

> **KEEP THE FOLDER TOGETHER**
>
> Void Compass keeps its settings, commander profiles, logs and downloaded data in the folder you unzipped it to. To move it, move the whole folder. Chapter 13 explains what's inside.

03 · FIRST-TIME SETUP

Four small steps

The first time you run Void Compass, a short setup links your journals and sets up the cockpit. It finds most things by itself.

Step 1 · Welcome

The welcome screen introduces Void Compass and greets the commander it found in your newest journal. Choose **LINK MY JOURNALS** to continue.



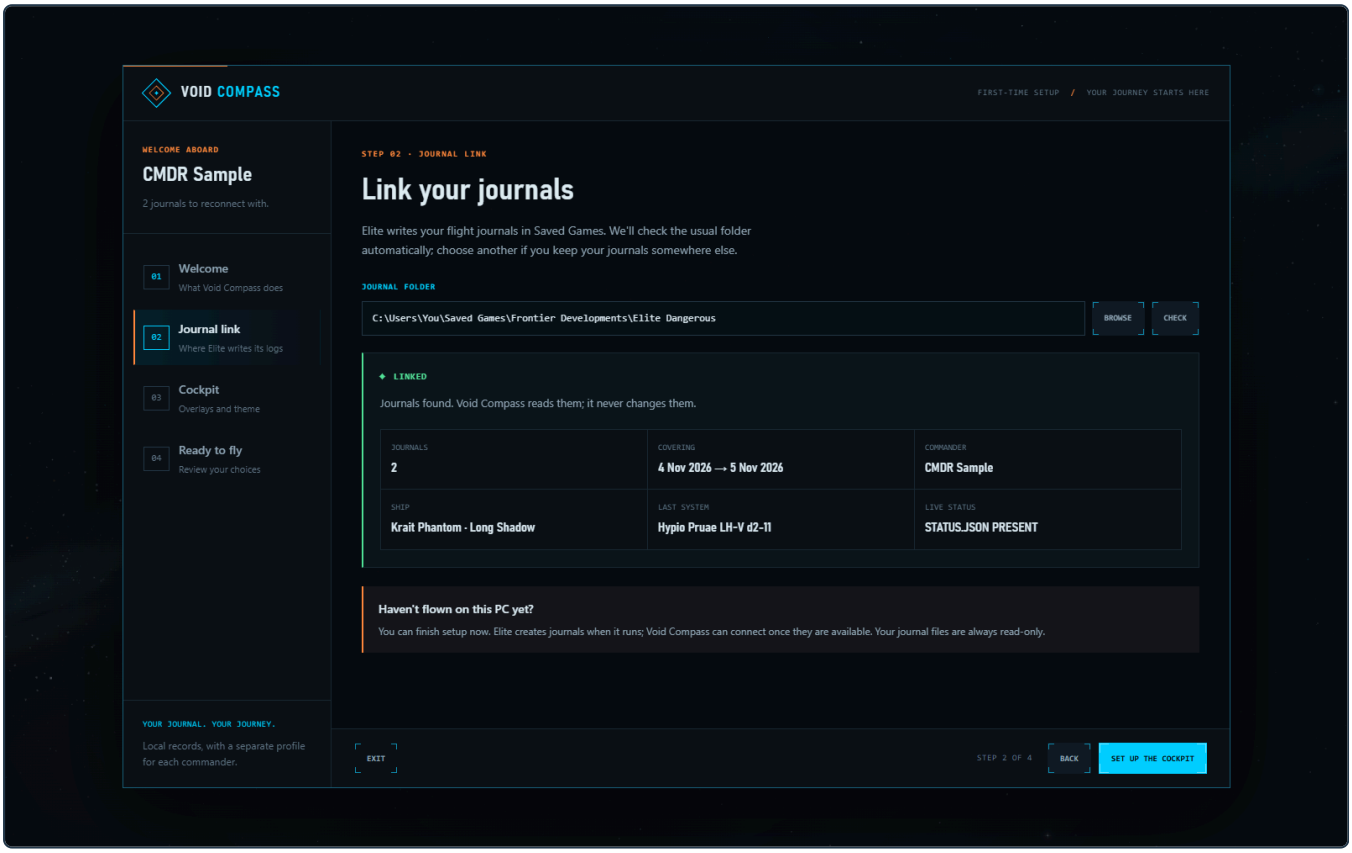
Welcome. The left column shows the four steps and the commander it found. **EXIT** leaves setup.

Step 2 · Link your journals

Elite writes its journals in your Saved Games folder, and Void Compass checks the usual place automatically:

`C:\Users\<You>\Saved Games\Frontier Developments\Elite Dangerous`

When it finds them you'll see **LINKED**, with how many journals there are, the dates they cover, your commander, ship and last system, and whether Elite's live status file is present. If you keep your journals elsewhere, choose **BROWSE**, pick the folder and press **CHECK**.



Linked. The readout confirms it's reading the right commander before you go on.

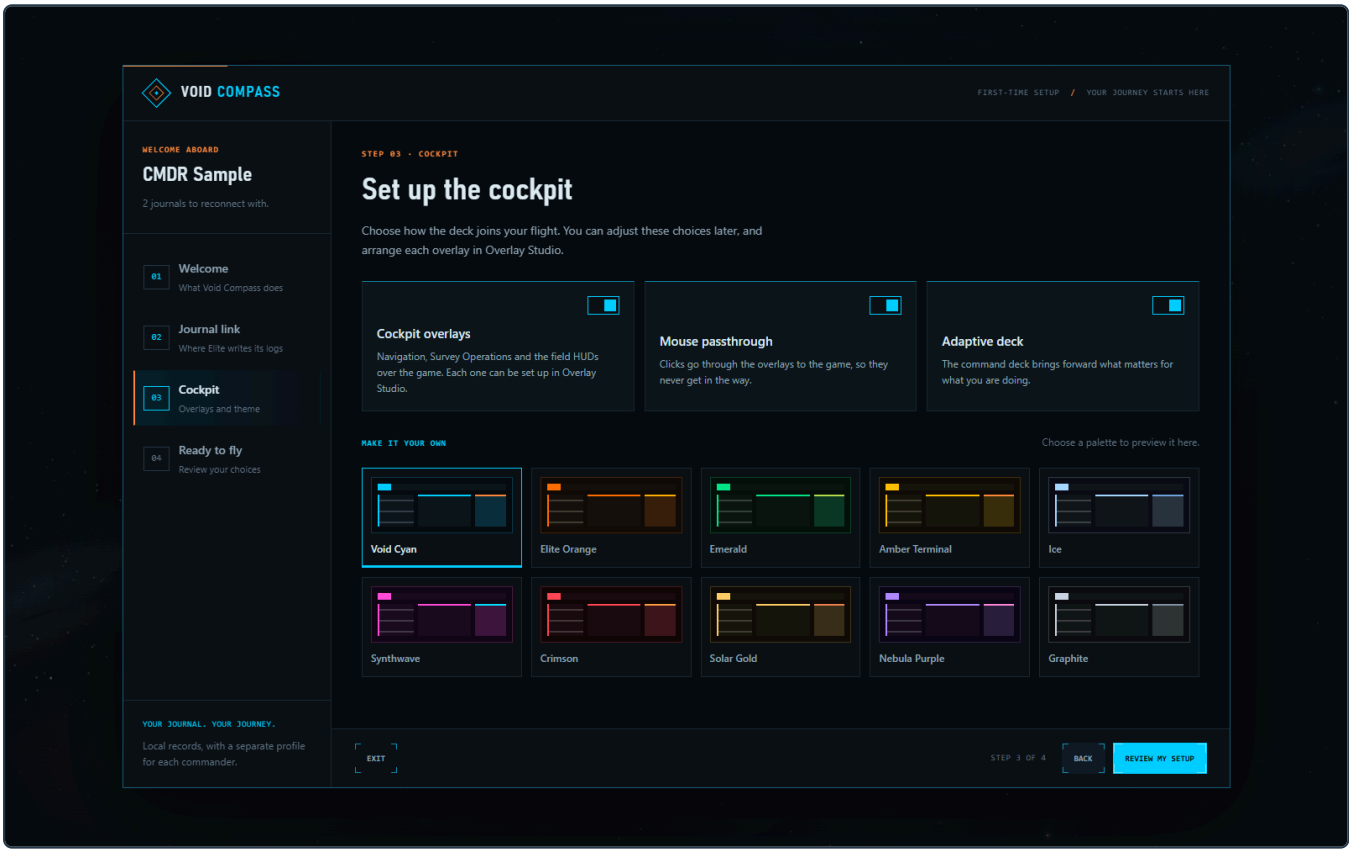
> **HAVEN'T FLOWN ON THIS PC YET?**
> You can finish setup anyway. Elite creates journals when it runs, and Void Compass connects as soon as they appear.

Step 3 · Set up the cockpit

Three switches decide how the deck joins your flight. You can change all of them later.

SWITCH	WHAT IT DOES
Cockpit overlays	Shows the Navigation HUD, Survey Operations and the field HUDs over the game. Each overlay can be set up on its own in Overlay Studio (chapter 9).
Mouse passthrough	Clicks go through the overlays to the game, so they never get in your way.
Adaptive deck	The command deck brings forward what matters for what you're doing.

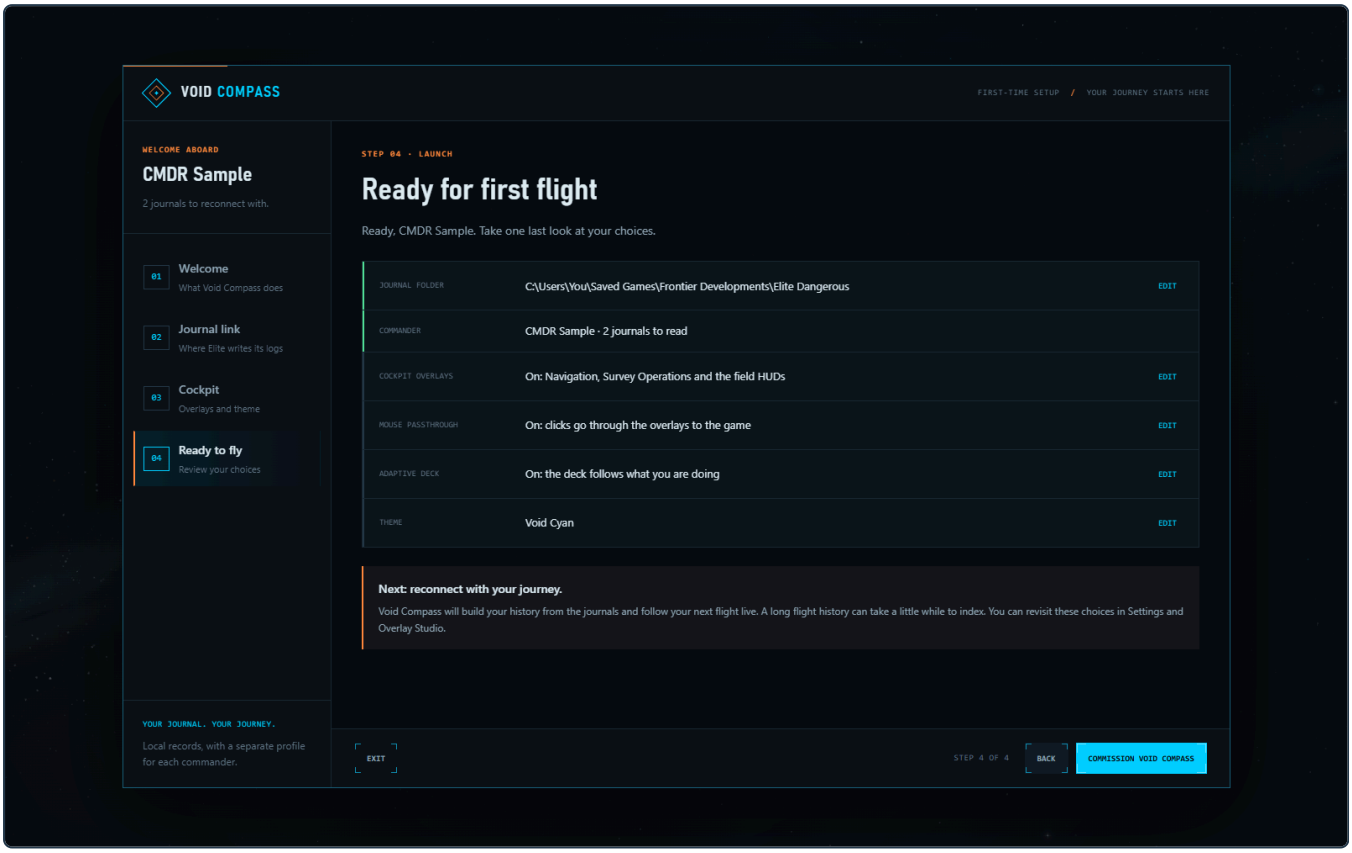
Below the switches, choose a theme. There are ten palettes, from Void Cyan to Elite Orange and Graphite, and the screen previews each one as you pick it.



Set up the cockpit. Overlays, passthrough, the adaptive deck and your theme.

Step 4 · Ready for first flight

Review your choices. Each line has an **EDIT** button that takes you back to that step. When you're happy, choose **COMMISSION VOID COMPASS**.



Review. Your journal folder, commander, overlays, passthrough, adaptive deck and theme.

The boot screen

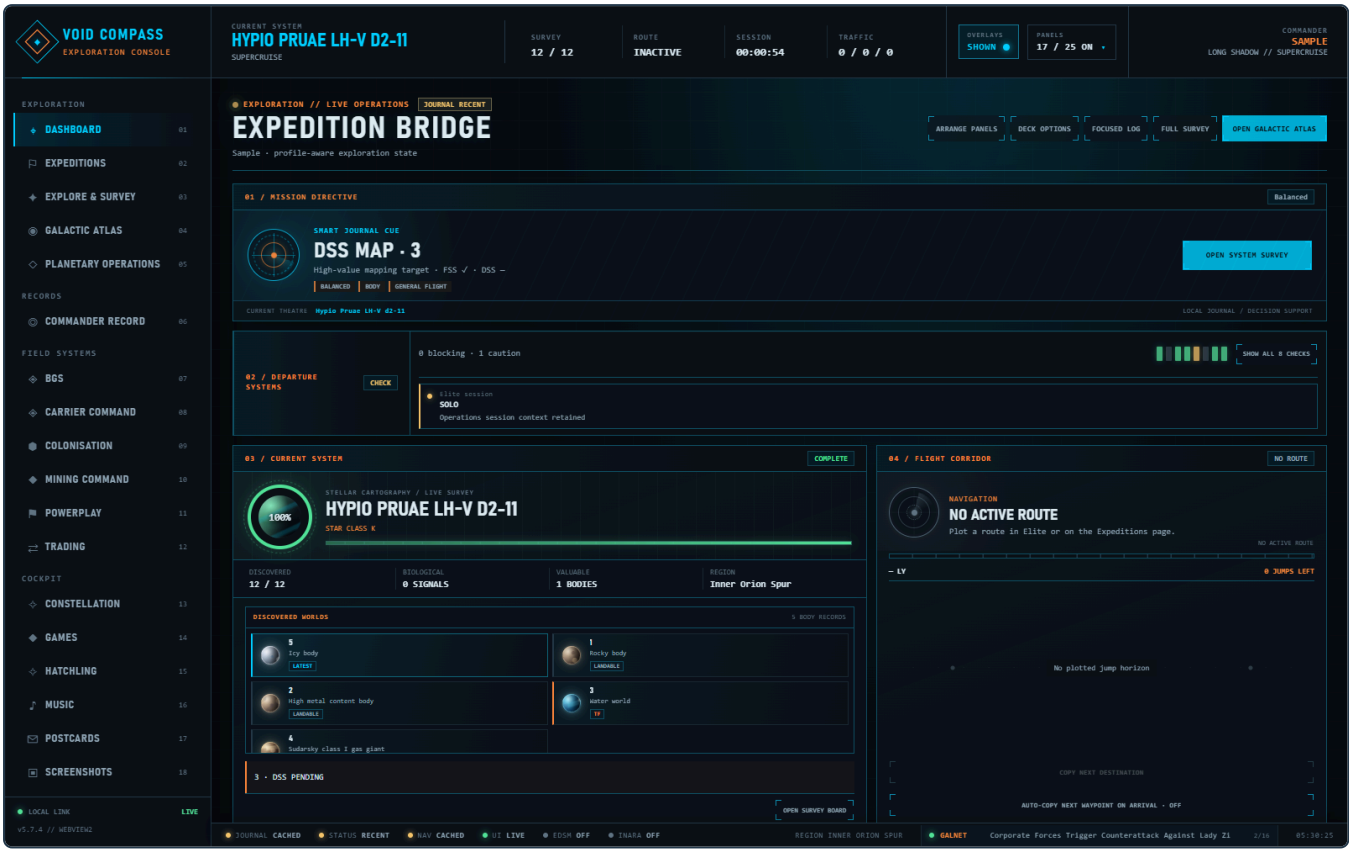
Void Compass now reads your journal history, all the way back to your oldest journal, so your record starts as far back as your journals go. A long history can take a little while the first time. After that, every start shows the boot screen for a few seconds while it catches up with your latest flight, then opens the deck.



Boot. Your commander, current system and ship, the journal catch-up and the systems coming online.

04 · THE COMMAND DECK

Finding your way around



The Dashboard. The left rail lists every page, the top bar shows where you are, and the status bar along the bottom shows what's connected.

The three bars

WHERE	WHAT'S THERE
Left rail	Every page, grouped: **Exploration** (Dashboard, Expeditions, Explore & Survey, Galactic Atlas, Planetary Operations), **Records** (Commander Record), **Field systems** (BGS, Carrier Command, Colonisation, Mining Command, Powerplay, Trading), **Cockpit** (Constellation, Games, Hatchling, Music, Postcards, Screenshots, Time Capsules, Void Wrapped, your companion) and **Application** (About, Overlay Studio, Settings, Tools).
Top bar	Your current system and what you're doing, survey progress, route, session time and traffic. **OVERLAYS** shows or hides every overlay at once; **PANELS** switches overlays on and off one by one. Your commander and ship are on the right.
Status bar	Lights for the journal, Elite's status file, the route, the deck itself, EDSM and Inara; your current region; and Galnet headlines.

The Dashboard

The Dashboard is the expedition bridge: everything about right now, on one page.

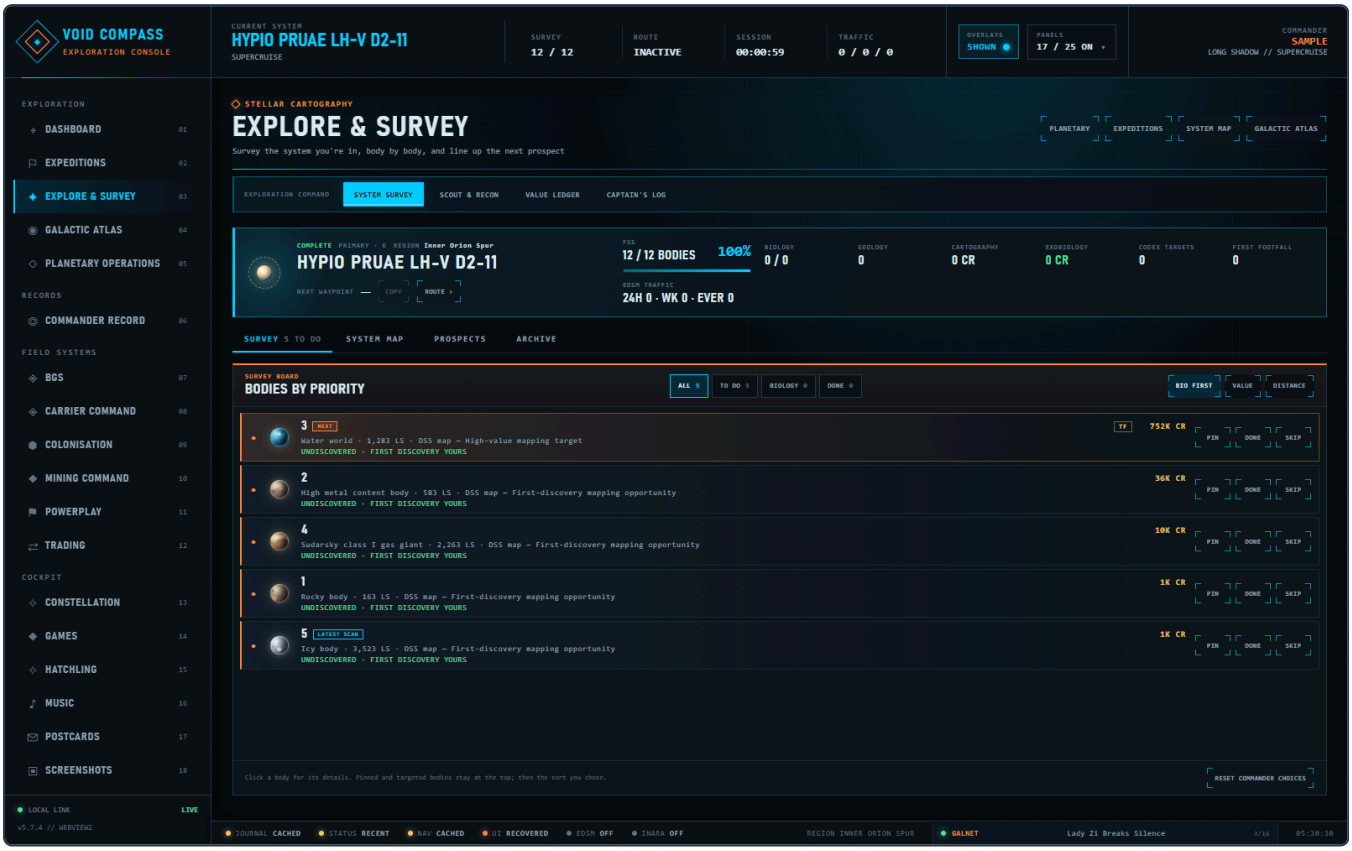
- **Mission Directive** suggests the most useful next thing to do here, such as a body worth mapping, fuel to scoop, or a Codex entry to log, and has a button to act on it.
- **Departure Systems** runs quick checks on your ship and session before a long trip. **SHOW ALL CHECKS** lists them.
- **Current System** shows survey progress, discovered worlds, biological signals and value, with a button to open the full survey board.
- **Flight Corridor** follows your plotted route, jump by jump.

> MAKE IT YOURS
>
> **ARRANGE PANELS** lets you move and hide Dashboard panels; **DECK OPTIONS** has the Dashboard's own settings; and **FOCUSED LOG** shows a running log of what's happened this session.

05 · EXPLORING

Explore & Survey

The survey board lists every body in the system you're in, most worthwhile first.

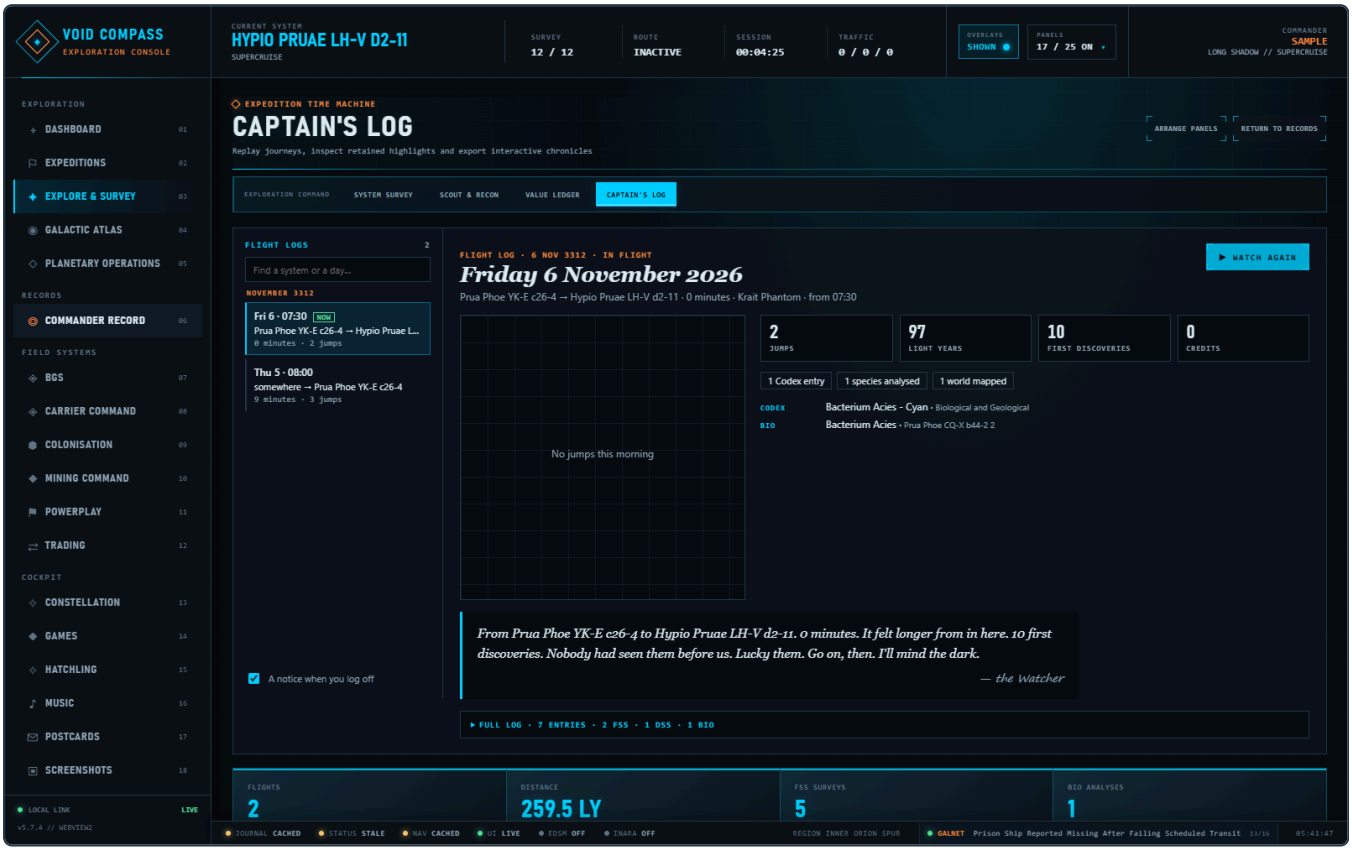


The survey board. Each body shows its type, distance, what it's worth to map and whether you're the first to discover it.

- The header shows the system's FSS progress, biology, geology, cartographic and exobiology value, Codex targets and first footfalls.
- Filter with **ALL**, **TO DO**, **BIOLOGY** and **DONE**, and sort by **BIO FIRST**, **VALUE** or **DISTANCE**.
- On each body, **PIN** keeps it at the top, **DONE** ticks it off and **SKIP** moves it out of the way. Click a body for its details.
- The tabs under the header switch to the **System Map** (a live 3D view of the system), **Prospects** and the **Archive** of systems you've surveyed.

The Captain's Log

Every trip you fly becomes a page in the Captain's Log: where you went, how far, what you discovered and what it was worth, with a short closing paragraph written and signed by the companion who was on watch. Open it from the **CAPTAIN'S LOG** tab of Explore & Survey. The list on the left holds every flight; **WATCH REPLAY** plays the trip back on the Galactic Atlas.



A flight log. Jumps, distance, first discoveries and credits for the trip, its Codex finds, and the companion's closing words.

06 · THE GALACTIC ATLAS

Everywhere you've been

The Galactic Atlas is an offline map of the galaxy's regions and everywhere your journals have taken you.



The Atlas. Your journey, the Jump To list and, on the right, the FOLLOW ME button with its description showing.

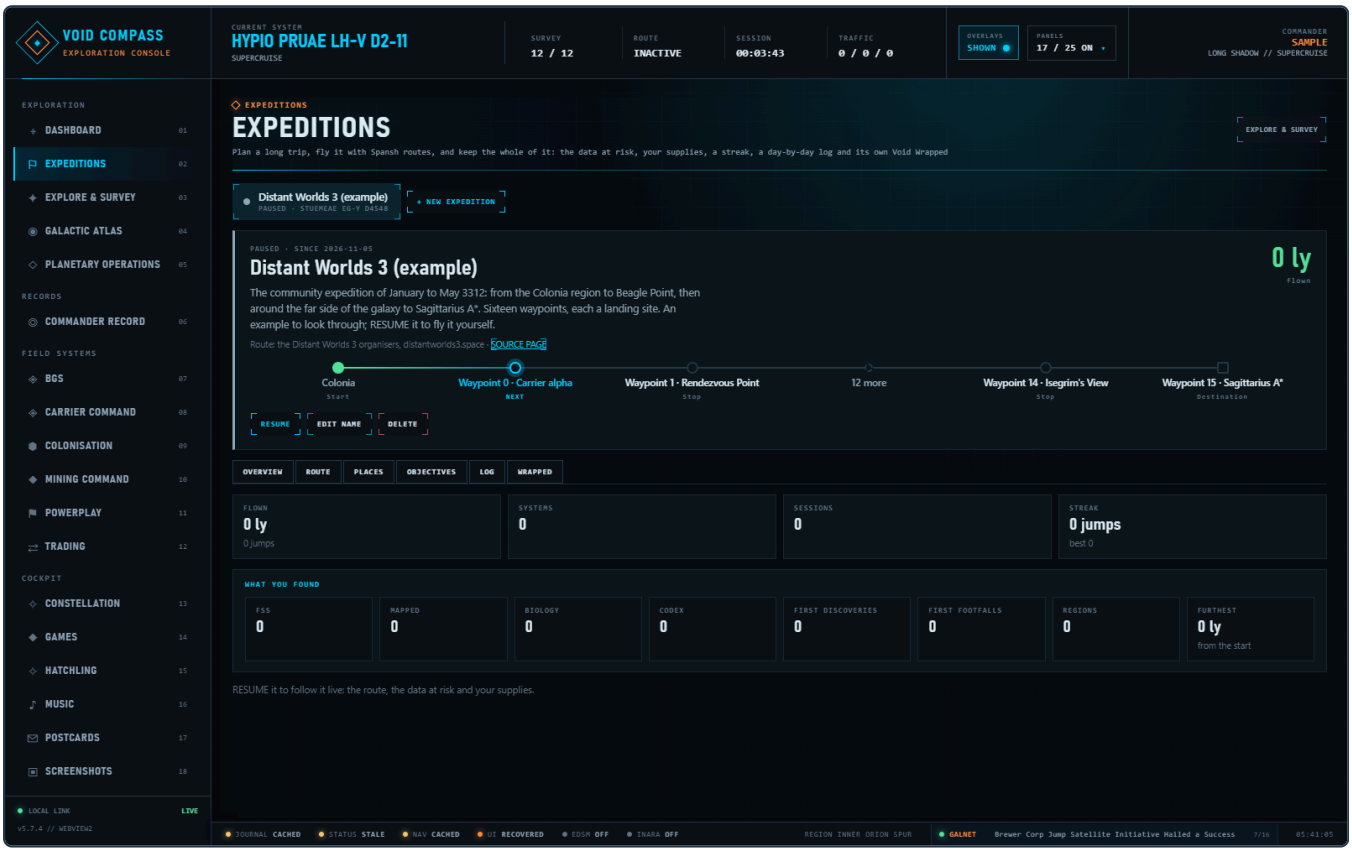
- **FIND** searches systems, regions and your own map marks. **Jump to** takes you straight to where you are, your whole journey, the whole galaxy or a famous place such as Sol, Sagittarius A*, Colonia or Beagle Point.
- **REGIONS**, **LAYERS** and **REC** show the regions you've visited, choose what's drawn, and open the Flight Recorder.
- Scroll or use **+** and **−** to zoom, drag to pan, and press **3D** to tilt the galaxy.
- The bar along the bottom totals your systems, distance and regions, and the play button replays your history jump by jump.

> FOLLOW ME
>
> Press **FOLLOW ME** and the Atlas keeps you (YOU ARE HERE) centred, moving with you every time you jump. Your zoom stays as it is. Drag the map to stop following.

Planning, landing and looking back

Expeditions

Plan a long trip, fly it with Spansh routes, and keep the whole of it: the route, your stops, objectives, a day-by-day log and its own story. The page comes with an example expedition to look through. Choose **NEW EXPEDITION** to start your own, and **RESUME** to pick it up where you left off.



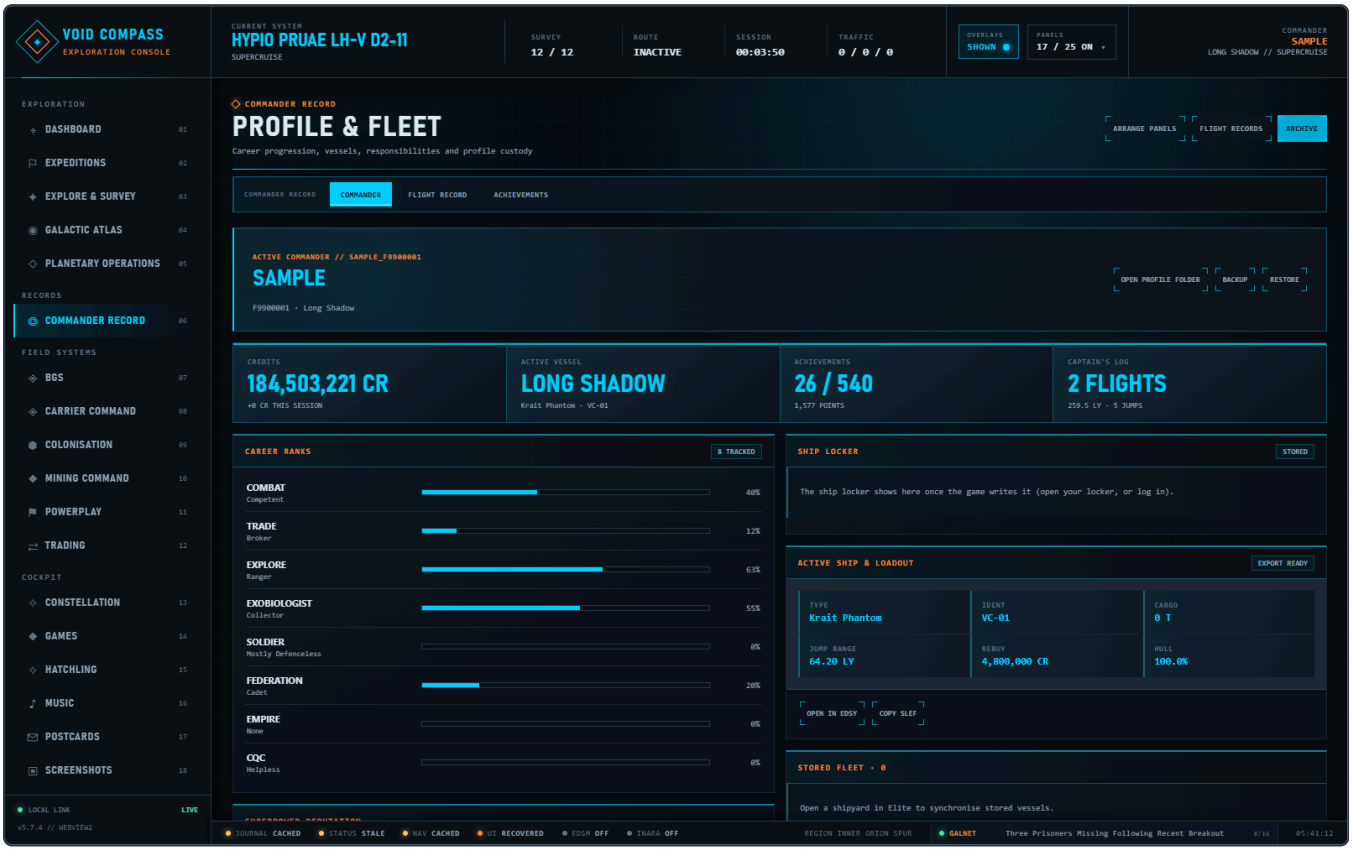
Expeditions. The route with its waypoints, and tabs for the overview, route, places, objectives, log and wrap-up.

Planetary Operations

Everything on a planet's surface, in three tabs. **On the ground** has a compass to any coordinates (or back to your ship) and a field map of your trail and samples. **Exobiology** shows what lives on the planet, what's worth sampling and how far to move before your next sample. **Sites** keeps the surface sites you've saved.

Commander Record

Your ranks and their progress, credits, ships and loadout, achievements and flight records, for the commander you're flying. Each commander has a separate record: Void Compass knows you by your Frontier ID, so renaming your commander in game keeps everything.



Profile & Fleet. Credits, active ship, achievements and Captain's Log totals, ranks and your ship's loadout.

Overlays in the cockpit

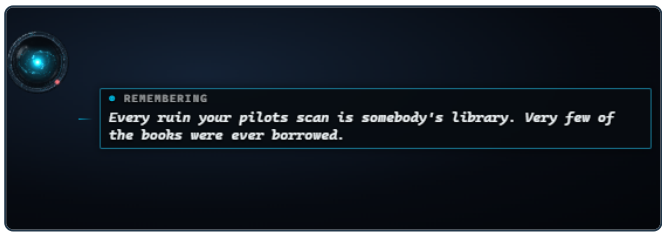
Overlays sit on top of the game. Each one can be switched on and off, moved and themed on its own.



Navigation HUD. Your ship, what you're doing (here, supercruise, with a holographic scene), fuel, the current system, the next jump and the system's survey progress.



Survey Operations. The bodies worth your time, with their value before and after mapping.



Your companion. The Watcher's eye, with a thought beside it.

Other overlays include Jump Info, the Deep Space Contact Scope, Cargo Manifest, Prospector Analysis, the Rig Tracker, Planet Materials, Station Information, Gravity Warning, Cockpit Notifications, Achievements, the Galaxy Minimap, Postcards, the Galnet Ticker and the Music Player.

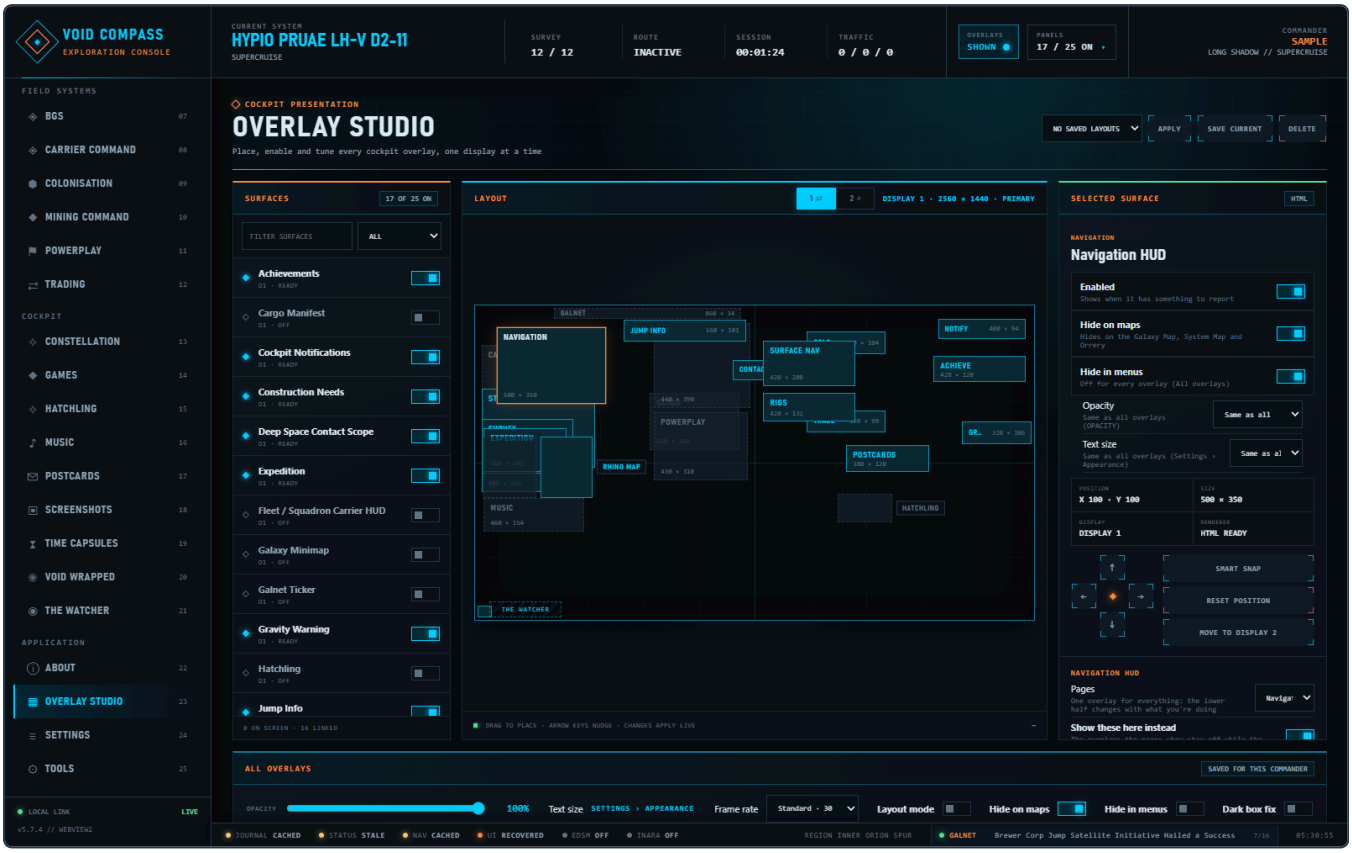
Turning overlays on and off

- **OVERLAYS** in the deck's top bar hides or shows every overlay at once.
- **PANELS**, next to it, switches each overlay on or off.
- Overlay Studio has every overlay's switch and all of its settings (chapter 9).

> OVERLAYS NEED A WINDOW TO SIT ON
>
> Run Elite in **Borderless** (or Windowed) mode, under Options › Graphics. Overlays can't draw over exclusive full-screen mode.

09 · OVERLAY STUDIO

Place and tune every overlay



Overlay Studio. Surfaces on the left, your monitor in the middle, the selected overlay's settings on the right, and settings for every overlay along the bottom.

1. **Pick an overlay** from **SURFACES**. Its switch turns it on or off; the filter box finds one by name.
2. **Place it** on the **LAYOUT**: drag it, or nudge it with the arrow keys. Changes apply live. If you have two monitors, the **1** and **2** buttons switch between them, and **MOVE TO DISPLAY 2** sends the overlay across.
3. **Tune it** in **SELECTED SURFACE**: hide it on the galaxy and system maps, hide it in menus, and set its own opacity and text size. **SMART SNAP** lines it up and **RESET POSITION** puts it back.
4. **Tune them all** in **ALL OVERLAYS**: opacity, frame rate, **Layout mode** (outlines every overlay in game so you can see where they are), and hiding on maps and in menus.
5. **Save the layout** with **SAVE CURRENT**, and bring back any saved layout with **APPLY**.

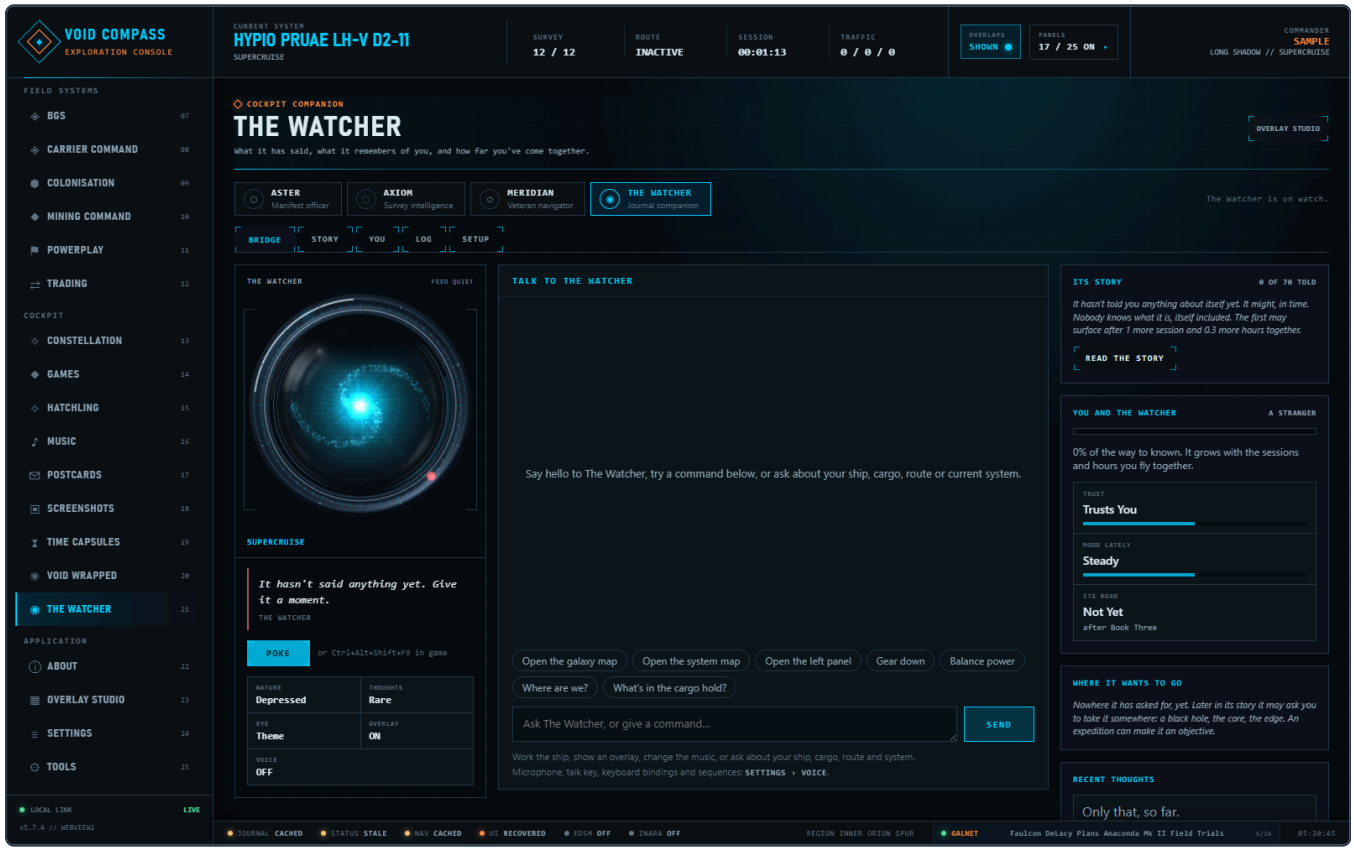
> **PER COMMANDER**
>
> Layouts and overlay settings are saved for the commander you're flying, so each commander can have their own cockpit.

10 · YOUR COMPANION

Company in the black

A companion watches your journal and thinks out loud beside its overlay: about what you're doing, where you've been and its own long story. It remembers you between sessions.

COMPANION	CHARACTER
The Watcher	An ancient, rather gloomy eye. The first aboard, and the oldest.
Aster	A precise ship's officer with a dry wit, who keeps the log.
Axiom	A curious survey intelligence that loves an empty record and a full count.
Meridian	A measured old navigator who marks every position and every long jump.



The companion page is named after whoever is on watch. Choose a companion along the top; the tabs below are BRIDGE, STORY, YOU, LOG and SETUP.

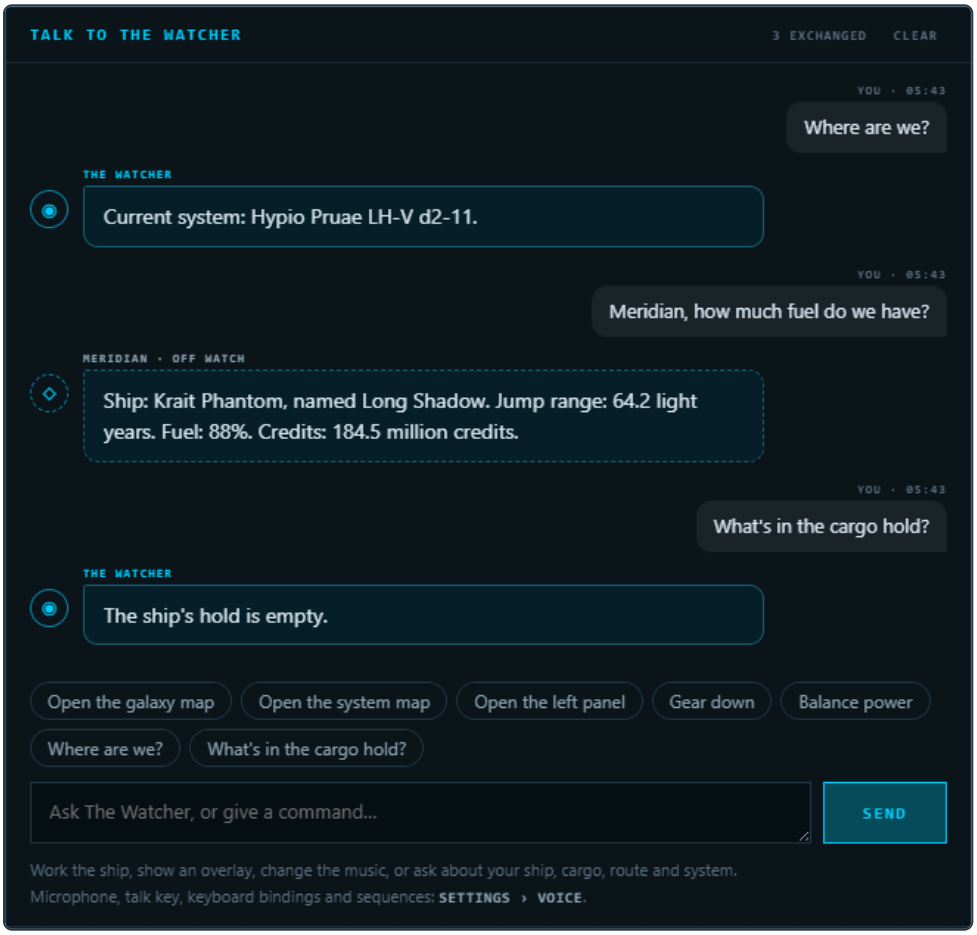
Choosing a companion

Click a name along the top of the companion page. The new companion takes the watch from the last one by name, and each keeps its own memory, story and settings, so you can switch back at any time. A companion's first watch starts at the same Thoughts setting as the Watcher.

Talking to your companion

Type in the TALK box on the **BRIDGE** tab, or click one of the examples. Your companion can:

- **answer questions** from your ship's systems: where you are, your fuel and jump range, what's in the hold, your route, the system's bodies, factions, missions, ranks and more;
- **work Elite's controls**: open the galaxy or system map, open cockpit panels, lower the landing gear, balance power and much more, using your own keyboard bindings;
- **run the app**: show or hide overlays and play or pause your music.



TALK. The Watcher answers "Where are we?"; Meridian, asked by name, answers off watch in a dashed bubble.

> ASK A CREWMATE
>
> Start with another companion's name, such as "*Meridian, how far to Colonia?*" or "*ask Axiom what's in this system*", and that companion answers in its own words and voice without taking the watch.

Its thoughts in game

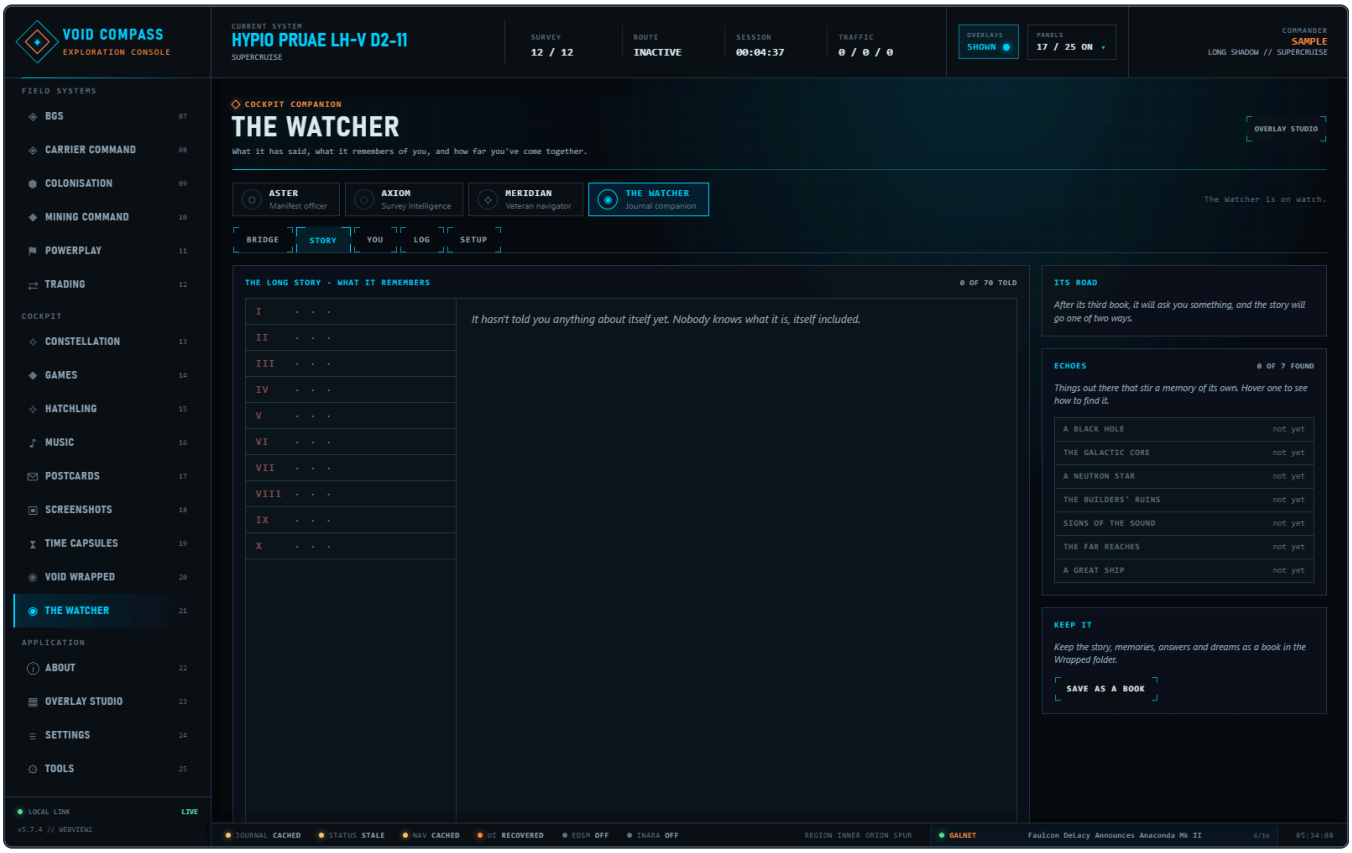
Thoughts appear beside your companion's overlay. How often it speaks up is the **Thoughts** setting on the **SETUP** tab: **Off**, **Rare**, **Occasional** or **Chatty**. Each companion cares most about its own work: Axiom about scans and maps, Meridian about jumps and distance, Aster about the log. Want a word now? Press **POKE**, or its hotkey in game (**Ctrl+Alt+Shift+F9** unless you change it).

Voices

Every companion can speak with its own voice, generated on your PC. On the **SETUP** tab, switch Voice on and download the voice (each is a one-off download into the app's models folder). Settings › Voice holds your microphone, the talk key for speaking to your companion, and the full list of ship commands.

Its story

Each companion has its own long story, told a passage at a time in quiet moments over many hours of flying. Chapters open with what you really do in game, such as first discoveries, long jumps, dockings and close calls, or simply with time together. The **STORY** tab shows what you've heard, and the crew's own accounts of how they came aboard.

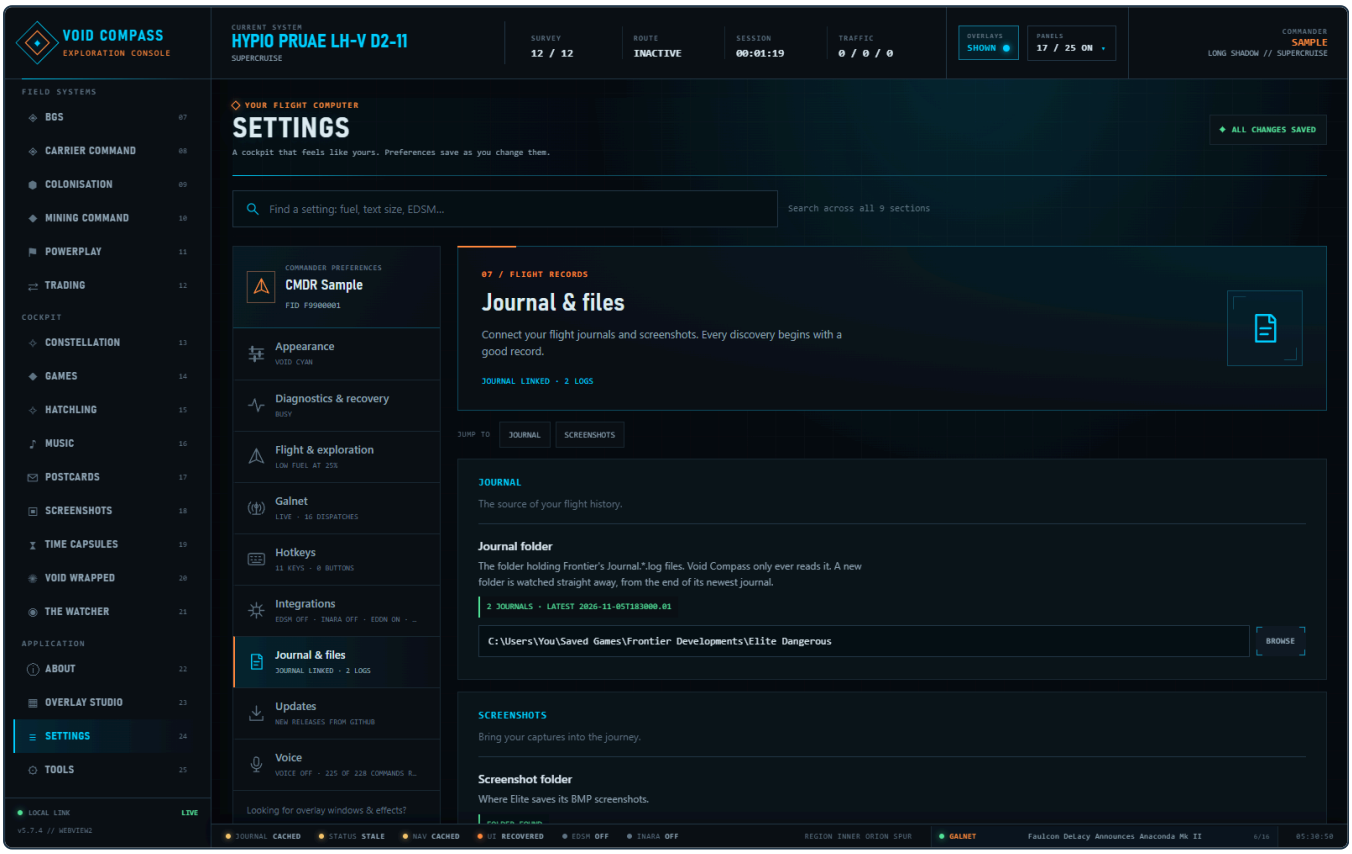


STORY. The chapters so far (sealed until they're told), the echoes you've found and the book you can save.

11 · SETTINGS

A cockpit that feels like yours

Settings save as you change them; the badge in the top corner says **ALL CHANGES SAVED**. Overlays have their settings in Overlay Studio; everything else is here.

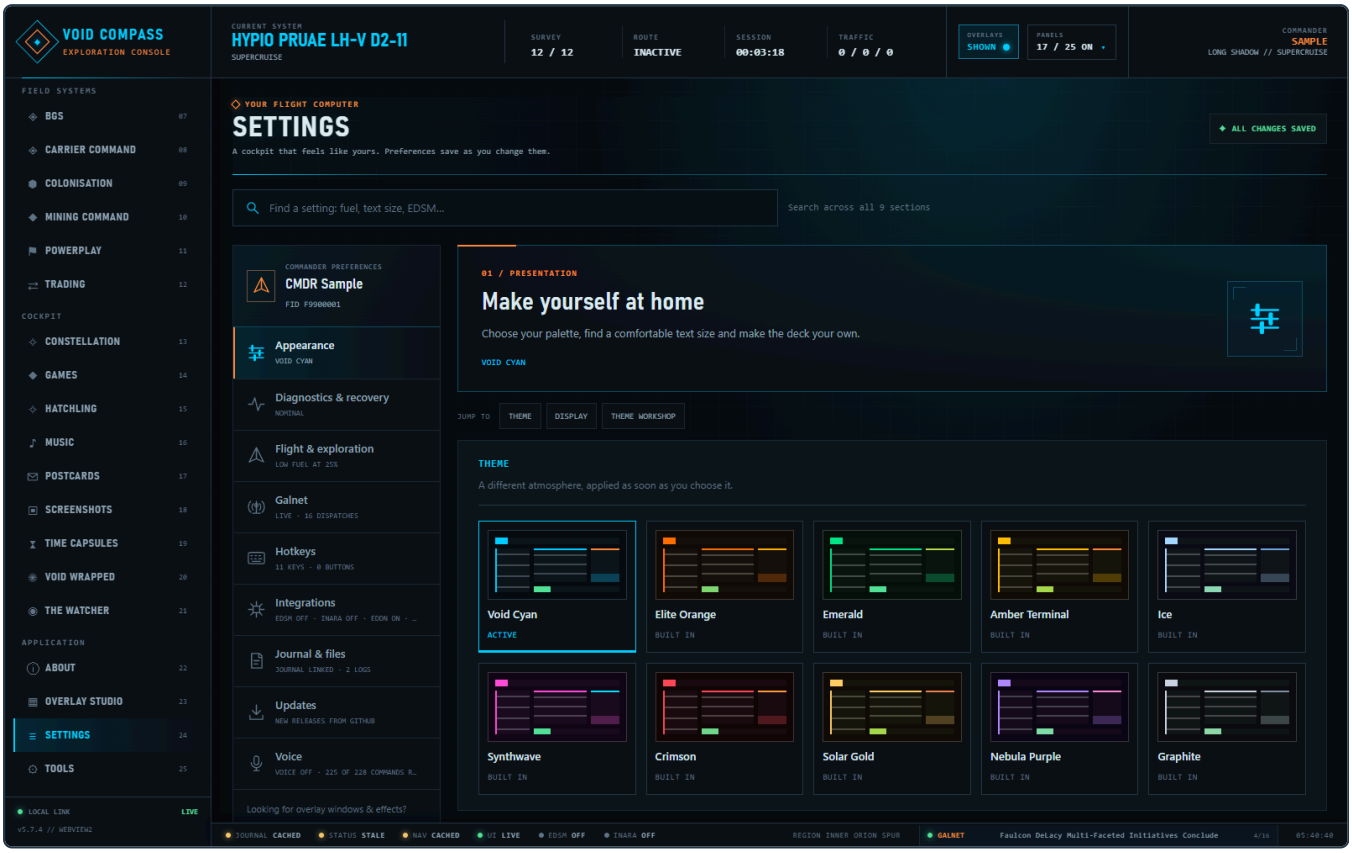


Settings. The search box finds any setting across all nine sections; the rail lists the sections.

SECTION	WHAT'S IN IT
Appearance	Theme, deck display and text size.
Diagnostics & recovery	Health checks and tools for when something isn't right.
Flight & exploration	Warnings such as low fuel, and exploration preferences.
Galnet	Galnet news on the deck and the ticker.
Hotkeys	System-wide keyboard shortcuts and controller buttons.
Integrations	EDSM, Inara, Raven Colonial, Spansh trading, EDDN, the Local API and Discord.
Journal & files	Your journal and screenshot folders.
Updates	Your version and new releases.
Voice	Talking by voice, your microphone, and the ship commands.

Appearance

Choose any of the ten themes; the deck and every overlay change straight away. Text size is here too, for the deck and the overlays together.



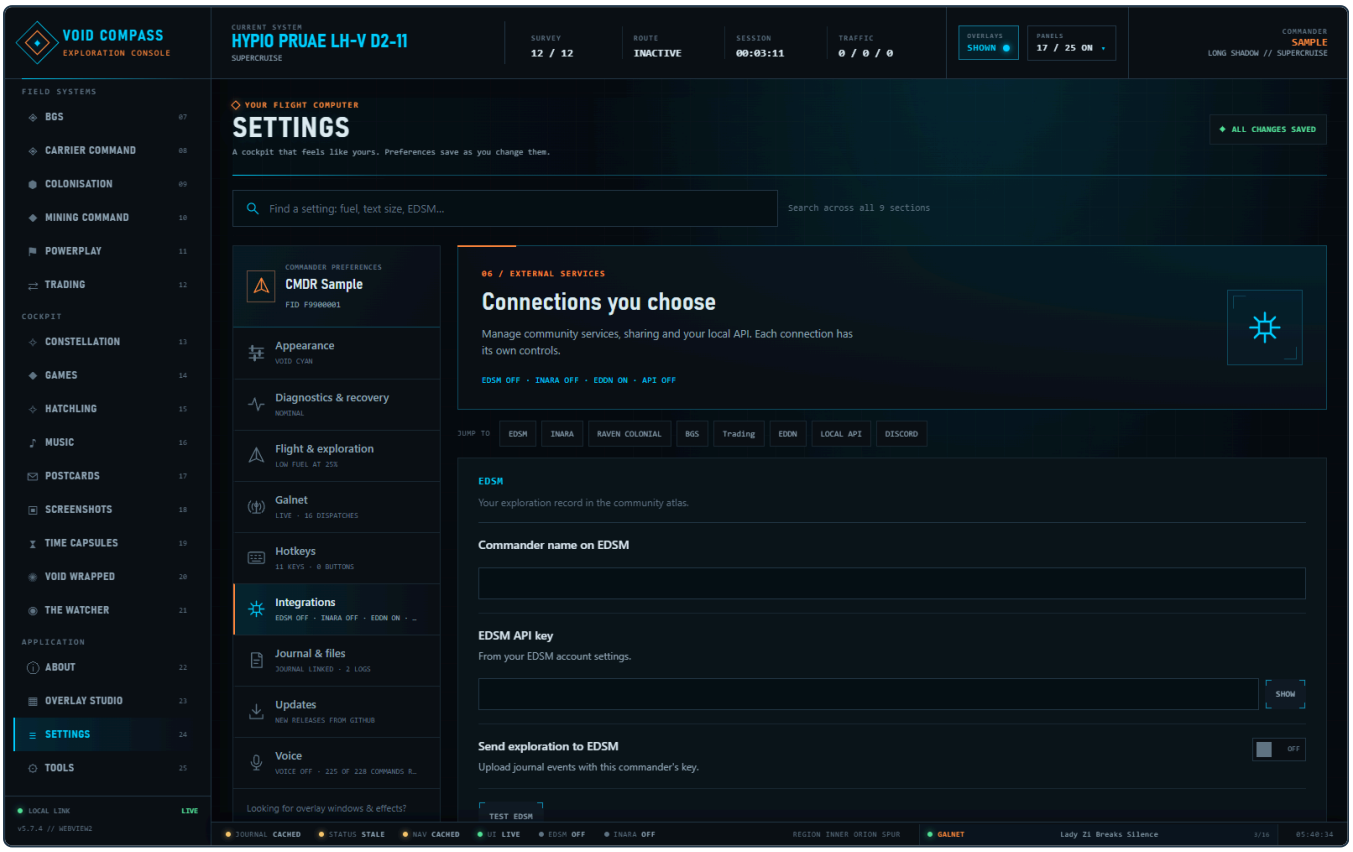
Appearance. Themes apply as soon as you choose them.

Hotkeys

Keyboard shortcuts work while Elite has focus. Click a shortcut and press the keys you want; controller buttons and combinations work too. Void Compass reads Elite's own bindings and warns you if a shortcut clashes with one.

Integrations

Void Compass works on its own. These services are optional, and each one can be switched off here.

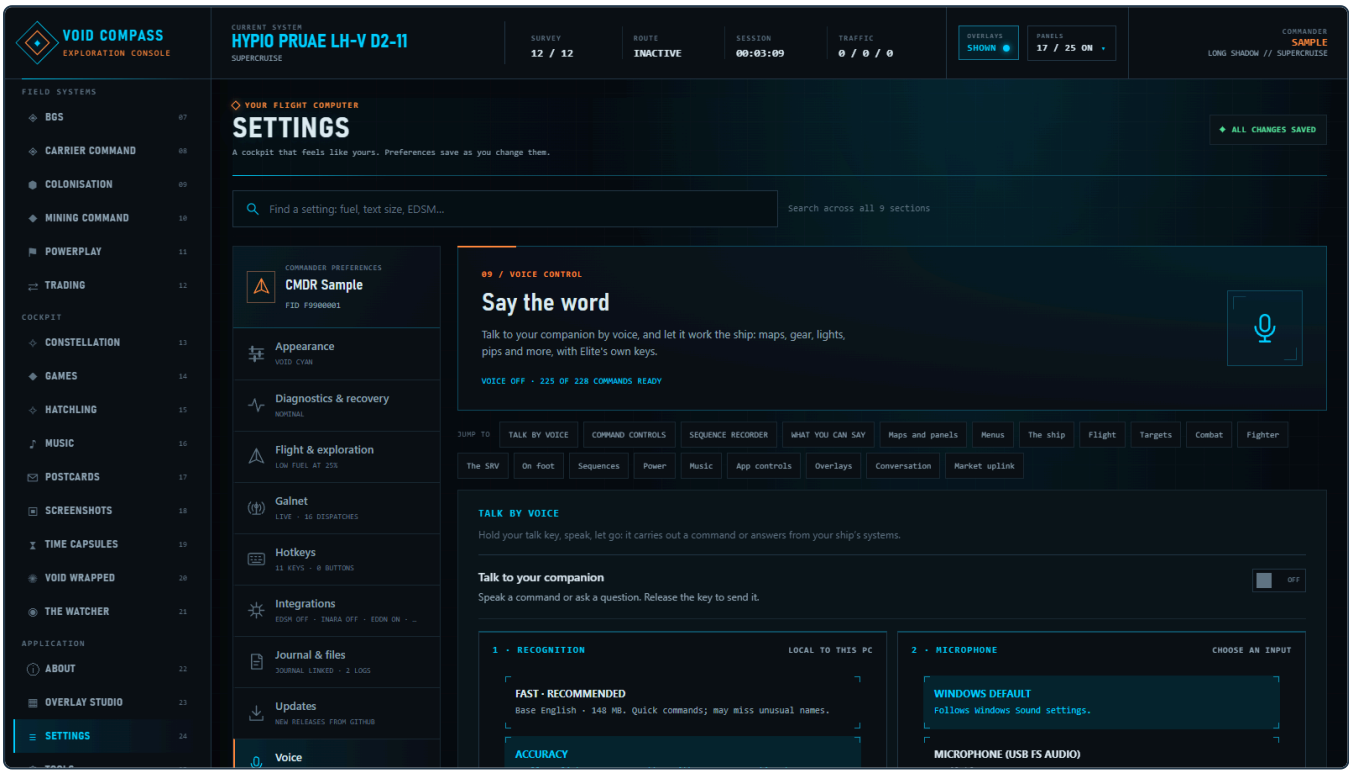


Integrations. Each service has its own section; jump straight to one with the buttons at the top.

SERVICE	WHAT IT'S USED FOR
EDSM	Uploading your journal (only once you add your EDSM name and API key and switch it on), plus system information and faction history for the BGS page.
Inara	Keeping your Inara profile up to date, once you add your API key and switch it on.
EDDN	Sharing the station markets you visit with the community.
Spansh	Only when you ask for a search: trade routes, prices, and rings and planets for mining.
Raven Colonial	Colonisation projects, once you add your own API key.
Local API	Lets your own scripts, Stream Deck buttons and stream widgets read and drive Void Compass on this PC. Off until you switch it on.
Discord	Carrier announcements, if you add a webhook.

Voice

Talk to your companion by voice: hold your talk key, speak, and let go. Speech recognition runs on this PC; choose **Fast** or **Accuracy**, and pick your microphone. Below that is every ship command your companion understands, with its phrases, and the sequences you can edit for multi-step actions such as requesting docking.



Voice. Talk by voice, recognition and your microphone, and jump links to every group of commands.

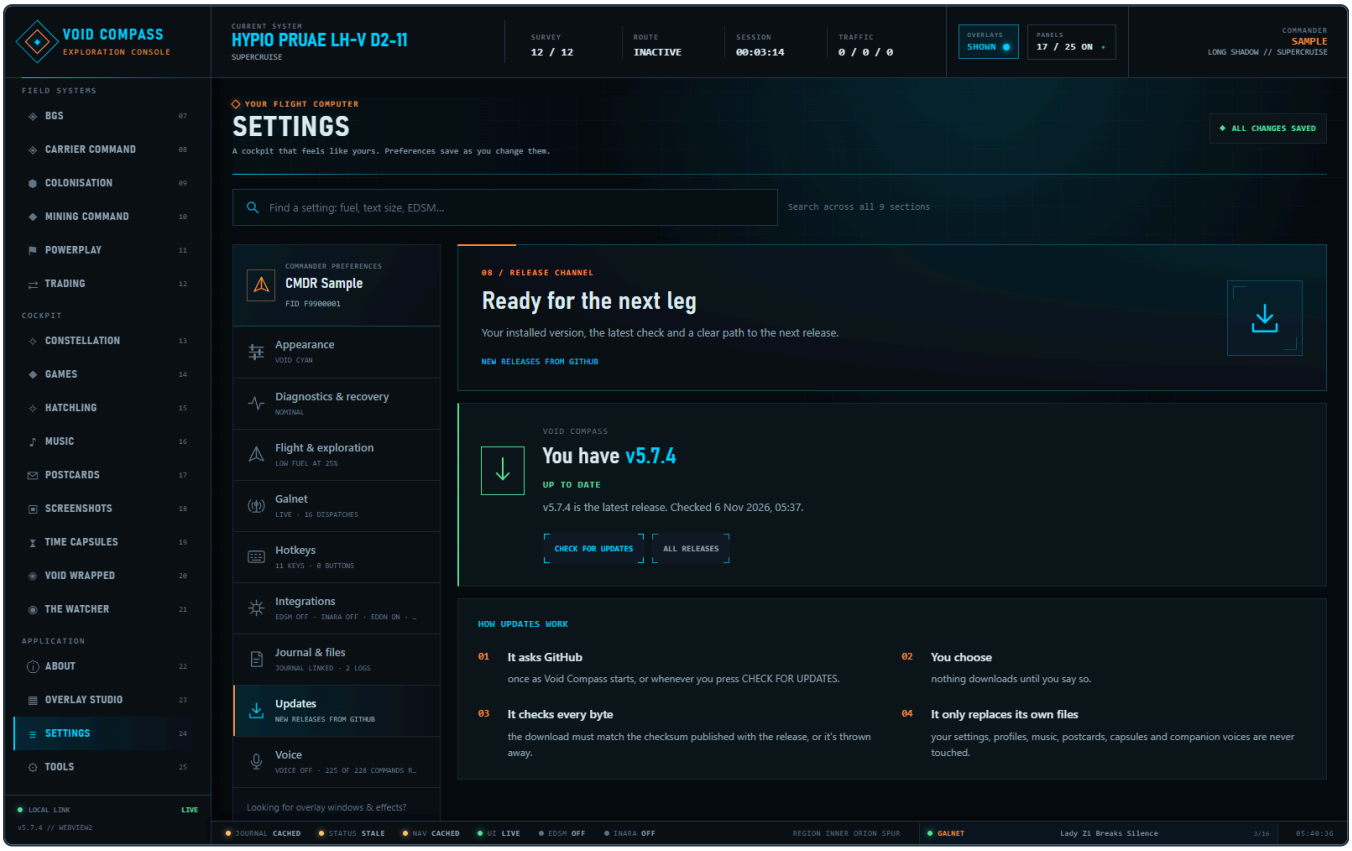
Journal & files

Your journal folder, and where Elite saves screenshots (Void Compass turns them into postcards). Use **BROWSE** to change either folder.

12 · UPDATES

Ready for the next leg

Void Compass can update itself, but only when you say so.



Settings › Updates. Your version, the last check and how updates work.

1. **It asks GitHub** once when it starts, and whenever you press **CHECK FOR UPDATES**.
2. **You choose.** Nothing downloads until you say so.
3. **It checks every byte.** The download must match the checksum published with the release, or it's thrown away.
4. **It only replaces its own files.** Your settings, profiles, music, postcards, capsules and companion voices are left untouched.

ALL RELEASES opens the release page, with the notes for every version.

Your data and your privacy

Everything Void Compass keeps lives in the folder you unzipped it to:

FOLDER OR FILE	WHAT IT HOLDS
`config.json`	App-wide settings, such as your journal folder.
`profiles\`	One folder per commander: history, settings, theme, overlay layouts, your companions' memories and the rest.
`backups\`	Automatic backups of your commander profiles.
`logs\`	Logs for troubleshooting.
`cache\`	Downloaded data that can be fetched again if it's deleted.

- **Each commander has a separate profile**, picked up automatically from the journal and keyed to the Frontier ID, so renames don't lose anything.
- **Nothing leaves your PC** unless you've switched on a service that sends it (chapter 11, Integrations).
- **To move or back up Void Compass**, copy the whole folder.

14 · TROUBLESHOOTING

If something isn't right

PROBLEM	TRY THIS
Overlays don't appear in game	Run Elite in Borderless or Windowed mode. Check **OVERLAYS** in the deck's top bar is showing, and that the overlay is switched on in Overlay Studio. Overlays hide on the galaxy and system maps and in menus if those options are on.
Not sure where an overlay went	Switch on **Layout mode** in Overlay Studio to outline every overlay in game, or use **RESET POSITION**.
Wrong commander, or no journal	Settings › Journal & files: check the folder, or **BROWSE** to the right one.
The deck window stays blank	Install the Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, then start Void Compass again.
Windows or your antivirus blocks the app	Community builds aren't code-signed, so some antivirus tools flag them by mistake. Check your download against the published checksum, allow the app, and report the false positive to your antivirus vendor.
Your companion is too quiet or too chatty	Change Thoughts on the companion page's **SETUP** tab. Each companion has its own setting.
Your companion doesn't speak	Switch Voice on and download its voice on the **SETUP** tab.

Getting help

Report a problem or suggest an idea at github.com/insert3coins/VoidCompass/issues. If something went wrong, attach the files from the `logs\` folder; they help find the cause quickly.

Fly safe, Commander. o7